
Chief Technology Office

Become a Bar Raiser – The Quintessential Talent Ambassador



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Feedback

Organizations thrive on great people, and people thrive in great organizations. What makes one a prized employee? Resourcefulness, being a "Role Model" to others, having an appetite to take calculated risk and a "Not afraid to fail" attitude. Similarly, a prized organization is one, which can attract and retain such employees. [The U.S. Department of Labor](#) estimates that a bad hire can cost an organization up to 30% of the employee's potential first-year expected earnings. Hence, it is very critical to attract the right talent.

Amazon started its [Bar Keeper](#) program in 1999 by creating a group of interviewers, who could identify the right set of candidates that fit the organization's culture and leadership parameters. Because the purpose of the program was to raise the standard with every new hire and not maintain it, the Bar Keepers eventually became the Bar Raisers. This meant that candidates

selected by the Bar Raiser had to be better than 50% of those performing similar roles in the organization.

In Philips, with our focus changing from healthcare to healthtech, Talent Acquisition, in association with the Software Center of Excellence, embarked on a similar journey in 2020. They have piloted the first **Philips Bar Raiser Program** with a 10-member team in Philips Innovation Campus in Bangalore. This was part of adopting best practices in the technology space and strengthening our focus on the "Workforce of the Future". After initiation, TA has successfully replicated the program across the US, EMEA and Blumenau.



The 10 Bar Raisers from Philips Innovation Campus Bangalore.

Journey so far and the milestones:

Milestone One: Initiation: One of the most critical and time-intensive phases was identifying the Bar Raisers. These individuals lead by examples, are very passionate about people and always go an extra mile to engage with the candidates. They are the influencers and the "go to" persons in any team. Simao William from the Software Center of Excellence also personally addressed the team and brought in his insights. Their work emulates our five behaviors, which constantly takes us closer to our mission.

Milestone Two: Preparation: The identified Bar Raisers had to go through a mandatory training session to understand the assessment and the evaluation process - STARR. This process focusses on drawing concrete examples from past behaviors, instead of predicting future actions. The training session helped the Bar Raisers prepare for a structured interview and provide

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feedback with substantial data. It also advocated the importance of a debrief session with all the interviewers in the hiring process.

Milestone Three: Experimentation: The team has conducted over more than 40 Bar Raiser interviews so far and the learning has been immense. Both candidates and hiring managers have expressed the value this particular round brings to the entire selection process. Candidates feel more vested and hiring managers get a very neutral and unbiased perspective.

A few testimonials

*"The program is my **Ikigai**, it aligns with my personal mission and helps me contribute towards building my organization's capability, provide deeper insights and enhance candidate experience" – Anasuya Rao Mohan, PIC Bar Raiser*

*"It was great speaking to **Suyog Gaidhani (PIC, Bar Raiser)**. I could feel the intensity of the questions to understand true motivation, passion, skills and most importantly my ambition. With this conversation, I am more interested in the opportunity with Philips" – A potential hire*

"Dear Datta, Very descriptive and detailed feedback. Really, appreciate this. I am seeing great value in having a Bar raisers interview round" – Hiring Manager, PIC

The program has led to an enormous cross-pollination of ideas, gaining insights into other businesses and most importantly, our Bar Raisers have become the quintessential ambassadors of our hiring process. The team meets every month to share experiences and learn from each other.

This has been our story so far from the India Bar Raiser Chapter; we will come back with the other stories from EMEA, US and Blumenau in our future editions. Find more information at [.Grow](#).

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